



## **JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE**

### **National Police College of Jamaica Student Grievance Policy and Standard Operating Procedures**

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| <b>Title: NPCJ Student Grievance Policy and<br/>Standard Operating Procedures</b> | <b>Number:<br/>JCF/NPCJ-TB/PL/SFs/0005/2025</b> |
| <b>Effective Date: 2025-Jan-01</b>                                                | <b>Pages: 6</b>                                 |
| <b>Review Date: nil</b>                                                           | <b>Distribution: NPCJ</b>                       |
| <b>Revision #: 0</b>                                                              | <b>Process Owners: ACP NPCJ</b>                 |
| <b>Rescinds: nil</b>                                                              |                                                 |
| <b>Authors: NPCJ</b>                                                              | <b>Owner: JCF</b>                               |
| <b>First Published: 2025-Jan-01</b>                                               | <b>Review: Triennially</b>                      |

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## **1.0 Introduction**

The National Police College of Jamaica (NPCJ) is committed to providing an excellent educational experience for its students, through appropriate academic, administrative, and welfare services and facilities. It is recognize that students may encounter concerns or grievances related to their educational experiences on occasion. This *Policy on Student Grievance and Standard Operating Procedures* therefore outlines the procedures for addressing student grievances and ensuring a fair and just resolution.

## **2.0 Purpose**

The purpose of this policy and standard operating procedure is to provide students with a structured process to express concerns and grievances related to actions or inactions by members of the college community. This policy aims to ensure fair, prompt, and transparent resolutions to these grievances.

## **3.0 Scope**

This policy and standard operating procedures applies students all campuses and training locations of the National Police College of Jamaica. It encompasses the procedure for handling Non-academic and academic grievance.

## **4.0 Policy Statement**

It is the policy of the NPCJ that all student grievances will be addressed fairly, transparently, and timely while upholding due process and respecting the rights of all parties involved.

## **5.0 Abbreviations and Acronyms**

**JCF** Jamaica Constabulary Force  
**NPCJ** National Police College of Jamaica

## **6.0 Definition**

**6.1 Grievance:** A matter of dissatisfaction, complaint or unfair treatment

**6.2 Academic Grievance:** Any dissatisfaction relative to academic matters, including curriculum, teaching quality, assessment, grading, and awards can file academic grievances.

**6.3 Non-Academic Grievance:** Any dissatisfaction or unfair treatment in areas other than academics. These may include concerns related to personal information and records, discrimination, harassment, sexual harassment, living conditions, fees, and more.

**6.4 Responsible Office:** An office designated to address matters of grievance

## **7.0 Responsibilities**

### **7.1 Responsible Offices for Grievances**

- 7.1.1 Students are advised to direct their grievances to the appropriate office based on the nature of the grievance. Where there are areas of discontent or dissatisfaction with any aspect of the organization encountered during their interaction with the NPCJ, that are not covered in the list below reference may be made to the JCF Grievance Management Policy and Standard Operating Procedures.

#### **7.2 Responsible Offices for Non-Academic Grievance:**

- i. Living Conditions / Facilities – Property Management and Logistics Department
- ii. Fees / Tuition / Other Charges – Director, Finance Office
- iii. Personal Information and Records - Student Registrar's Office
- iv. Discrimination - Programme/Course Coordinator
- v. Sexual Harassment – refer to JCF Sexual Harassment Policy

#### **7.3 Responsible Offices for Academic Grievance:**

- i. Teaching Quality / Curriculum – Dean, Academic Studies
- ii. Assessment / Grading – Registrar, Examinations
- iii. Academic Advising - Dean, Academic Studies

## **8.0 Standard Operating Procedure**

The following procedures outline the standard for treating with student grievances:

### **8.1 Informal Resolution**

- 8.1.1 Before invoking the formal grievance procedure, students may resolve their concerns informally by:

- i. discussing the grievance with the person involved as soon as possible; it is recommended that a witness be present.

- 8.2 Alternatively, presenting the grievance in writing to the person involved, who must respond promptly, either orally or in writing.

### **8.3 Formal Resolution**

#### **8.3.1 Initial Review**

- 8.3.1.1 Where informal resolution is unsuccessful, or if students are not satisfied with the response, the following formal grievance process will obtain:

- i. the student must submit the grievance in writing to the relevant office (as outlined in the "Responsible Offices for Grievances" section) within 30 days from the date of the incident. If the grievance is against a department head or office, the student should address it to the next supervisory level;

- ii. all relevant supporting materials and clearly state the desired remedy must be included in writing;
- iii. the responsible office will conduct an investigation as necessary to resolve factual disputes;
- iv. if requested by the student, an impartial fact-finding panel of no more than three members may be appointed to investigate the grievance. The terms and conditions of the investigation will be provided in writing;
- v. the Responsible Office will make a determination and communicate the decision in writing to the student and the person involved within 10 working days of receiving the panel's report. The decision will include reasons and any recommended remedial actions.

#### **8.4 Appeal Procedures**

8.4.1 In circumstances where an aggrieved student is not satisfied with the decision of the Responsible Office after the initial review:

- i. the student may submit the written grievance, along with the initial decision, to the supervisor of the Responsible Office, and
- ii. depending on the severity of the grievance, another Administrator may be appointed or a Grievance Committee may be established.

#### **8.5 Grievance Committee**

8.5.1 Where the matter remains unresolved, a Grievance Committee may be convened;

- i. The Grievance Committee will consist of three members, including one from the student representation body (if available) and two from the college faculty/department or administration. These members should have no detailed knowledge of the dispute;
- ii. the parties involved will attend a grievance hearing before the committee, where they will present evidence and arguments. The parties will receive written notification of the hearing's time, date, and place.
- iii. The Grievance Committee's decision will be determined by a majority vote, and the decision will be rendered in writing within 14 calendar days following the hearing;
- iv. The Committee's decision will be final and binding; and
- v. Students filing an appeal will receive notification of the Committee's decision by communication to their official JCF emails or by registered mail to their last official address where there are no members of the JCF.

**9.0 Legislative Authority/Guiding Principles**

- 9.1 JCF Grievance Management Policy and Standard Operating Procedures,
- 9.2 JCF Sexual Harassment Policy,
- 9.3 NPCJ Quality Assessment Policy and Standard Operating Procedures, and the
- 9.4 Student Prospectus and Faculty Handbook.

**10.0 Relevant Records/Forms**

Nil